COLD FRONT — Design Philosophy & Token System

A visual movement for CANEPHORA, the insurgent flank of Karmic Circle Coffee Trading

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I. THE MOVEMENT: "MISREGISTERED"

Luxury coffee communicates through perfect registration. Gold foil hits its mark. Serifs sit exactly on the baseline. Nothing is out of place, because being out of place is the visible evidence of labor, and labor is what luxury is designed to hide.

This movement does the opposite. **Misregistration is the thesis.** Every headline prints twice — once in press black, once in fluorescent pink, offset by a few millimetres — because the gap between the two impressions is where the truth lives. The gap is the farmgate price versus the shelf price. The gap is the cup score versus the cupper's mood. The gap is what the label says and what the ledger says. You cannot look at this work without seeing the seam.

The material vocabulary is **duplicator ink on cheap paper**: riso and mimeograph, the technology of the pamphlet, the union hall, the show flyer stapled to a telephone pole at 3 a.m. Two spot inks, no process colour, no gradients pretending to be light. Where the two inks overprint they go dark and muddy and the paper shows through the halftone — this is not a defect to be corrected, it is the entire point. The work must look pressed, not rendered: ink starvation at the edge of a solid, dot gain in the shadows, the ghost of the roller. Achieving this convincingly is far harder than achieving polish, and the difficulty must be visible in the result. Every misalignment is deliberate and measured to the pixel; nothing here is sloppy, and the distinction between *rough* and *careless* is the whole craft.

Scale is violent and unapologetic. Display type arrives at the size of a shout and is set in a condensed grotesque with no romance in it — a face designed to fit more words on a picket sign. It runs to the trim, it breaks across lines where the breath breaks, and it never apologises by centering itself. Around it, the utility type is small, monospaced, and clinical: lot codes, pH values, temperatures, dates, weights. This is the second discipline of the movement — **the shout must always be flanked by the receipt**. Anyone can be loud. Only the honest can be loud *and* itemised. The monospace numbers are what make the poster an argument rather than a tantrum.

Composition follows the logic of the paste-up board, not the grid system: hard left rules, tape marks, stamps rotated a few degrees off true, redaction bars sitting over words the industry uses to avoid saying anything. Negative space is not luxurious breathing room — it is the unprinted paper of a cheap run, and it should feel like scarcity rather than abundance. Colour carries meaning and is never decorative: **blue is cold, black is fact, pink is danger and dissent.** A reader should be able to navigate any document in this system by colour alone, from ten feet away, in bad light.

The final requirement is craftsmanship of the kind that hides inside apparent roughness. This work must read as though it was made by someone who has run a real press for twenty years and knows exactly which imperfections a press produces and which ones it never would. Every halftone frequency, every ink offset, every degree of stamp rotation must be chosen and defended. The result should look like it cost nothing and took forever.

II. THE THEME: `cold-front-riso`

A custom theme, generated for this brief. None of the ten preset themes carry the position.

Palette — 2 inks + paper

Token	Hex	Role
`--paper`	`#EDE6D6`	Newsprint ground. Everything sits on it.
`--paper-2`	`#E0D7C2`	Second sheet — panels, insets, tables.
`--ink`	`#141310`	Press black. Body copy, rules, all fact.
`--cold`	`#0B4FFF`	Cryo Blue. Cold brew, data, instruments, measurement.
`--hot`	`#FF3D8B`	Fluoro. Dissent, danger, fail states, the ghost impression.
`--overprint`	`#3A1560`	Where cold and hot cross at multiply. Used sparingly.
`--grey`	`#6E6759`	Captions, footnotes, the quiet register.

Colour law: blue = measured, black = true, pink = contested or dangerous. Never use pink for decoration. Never use blue for emotion.

Type — three roles

Role	Face	Use
Display	**Anton**	Headlines, 48–140px, uppercase, tight tracking, printed twice with pink offset.
Body	**Archivo**	15–18px, 400/600. Argument, paragraphs, tables.
Utility	**IBM Plex Mono**	10–13px, uppercase, +0.12em tracking. Lot codes, pH, °C, hours, prices, footers.
House voice	**Fraunces**	Italic pull-quotes only — the one thread back to Karmic Circle's parent identity.

Archivo, IBM Plex Mono and Fraunces are inherited from the Greensheet 170-token system. Anton is new and belongs only to CANEPHORA. That is the brand-architecture signal: **the insurgent shares the parent's body, not its face.**

Signature devices

1. **The ghost impression** — display type duplicated in `--hot` at `translate(3px, 3px)`, sitting behind the black.
2. **The receipt strip** — any large claim is immediately followed by a monospace line of the numbers that support it.
3. **Redaction bars** — black boxes over industry euphemisms, with the honest word set beneath.
4. **The stamp** — rotated 4–7°, blue or pink outline, monospace, used for status: `AUDIT-READY`, `FLOOR MET`, `UNVERIFIED`.
5. **Halftone + grain overlay** — a radial-gradient dot field at low opacity over solid fields; paper fibre via layered noise.
6. **Tape rules** — section dividers drawn as short, slightly rotated bars rather than full-width hairlines.

Register discipline (governs tone, not just colour)

The house rule inherited from Karmic Circle applies without exception:

- **Consumer / trade press layer** — full punk. The provocation is the product.
- **Roaster / buyer layer** — sharp but collegial. Every roaster paying the floor is a partner, not a target.
- **Farmer / collector / processor layer** — **no punk at all.** Names, prices, procedures, respect. The Fermentation Cookbook uses this system's colours and grid but none of its aggression, because you do not sell revolution to the people already carrying the risk.

One truth. Three volumes.